

Tools you'll need

For Windows users, we recommend installing an awesome piece of free software called FlashDevelop and get running in these easy steps:

1. Download and Install FlashDevelop from <http://www.flashdevelop.org>
2. Download the latest version of the Adobe Flex SDK (located under the Adobe Flex SDK column on <http://opensource.adobe.com/wiki/display/flexsdk/Download+Flex+3>)
3. Unzip all the Flex files into a location you can remember.
4. Download the Windows Flash Player 10 Projector content debugger from <http://www.adobe.com/support/flashplayer/downloads.html>
5. Download that EXE file and put it in the same folder you placed your Flex SDK.
6. Next we're going to point FlashDevelop to the Flex SDK. Start it up and in the file menu go to: Tools -> Program Settings and choose the AS3 Context tab on the left side of the window. Scroll the window down to the field that says Flex SDK Location. Set this location to where you unzipped the Flex SDK files in the previous step. Then select the Flash Viewer tab on the left side, and set the External Player Path to the location of your Debug Flash Player downloaded in the previous step.
7. Get going to write your new game prototype.

Mac users can use Flash Builder trial http://www.adobe.com/go/try_flashbuilder

PROS

- ▶ Available Freely, Using FlashDevelop and Flex combo is free, instead of paying up to \$700 to buy a license of Adobe Flash.
- ▶ For anyone new to creating games, they can use some of best libraries: FLIXEL, FLASHPUNK etc that are free and cover the fundamentals of 2D games, including sprites, tile maps, collisions, and scrolling.
- ▶ Support for awesome libraries including TweenLine for “tweening” objects and variables, and Box2D for awesome 2D physics like wheels, ropes and springs.
- ▶ Almost everyone with a computer can play it. Upload your finished game on web so you can share it with the rest of the world!
- ▶ Using FlashDevelop to code is much easier due to the code predictor similar to Intellisense.
- ▶ Code editing in Flash is really bad, so FlashDevelop or Flex itself is better.
- ▶ It's Open Source and hence free of cost!